



free will
and
determinism

A large orange circle with a subtle drop shadow, containing the text "against compatibilist free will" in white, bold, sans-serif font.

**against
compatibilist
free will**

against
incompatibilist
free will

We can lay out this puzzle in terms of the following master argument against the reality of free will.

1. Free will is incompatible with determinism.
 2. If Libertarianism is true, then there is no free will.
-

C. There is no free will.

The master argument against the reality of free will

A compatibility believer in free will rejects premise (1). An incompatibilist believer in free will rejects premise (2).

Let's start with (2), which says that Compatibilism is false.

Now, so far we have been given no reason to think that either premise (2) or premise (3) is true. We're now going to look at two arguments — one for (2), and one for (3).

Compatibilist views of free will can be hard for some to get their minds around. How **could** I have free will if everything about me is, ultimately, determined by factors outside of my control?

It may help to sketch one story of compatibilist theory of free will to help you to see why the view should be taken seriously. What does it take for an action of yours to be free?

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future is not just a future with the state of the

2. None has any choice about DIDS ATJR.

nature say that if DINS ARE happy,

4. If determinism is true, the laws of

of interest.

then DECISION happens. (3)

varlatatie + the last of the

~ If none has about choice about whether P,

6. If $\det A$ is true, then A has any

happened in the distant past.

theorie about the fact that if DNR

3. If determined, the only one

1. No one has any choice about events which

if P , then Q , then one has any choice

C. If determinist is true, then no one has any

choice about DECISION (2, 6, 7)

5. No one has any choice about what the laws



and none has any choice about whether,

about whether @.

then DECISION. (4,5)

rules out free will.

combination of four - that No

choice principle, and determinism

one has any choice about the past, no

This argument seems to show that the

choice about the laws of nature, then no

Since the first three of these theses

hence that free will is incompatible with

seems to show that if determinism is

true, there are no free actions — and

dearminism.

seem quite plausible, the argument





The master argument against the reality of free will

Real/|the master argument:

tempting to reply to the master argument by denying premise (2).

in free will, and find the consequent argument persuasive, it looks

The consequence argument is a defense of premise (1). If you believe

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The master argument against the reality of free will

Consider the action of chopping a salad at the dining hall. Suppose that

you know that the following are all true:

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